

Bahrain's CRA Module

Volume 6 of the CBB Rulebook. The framework governing all crypto-asset business in Bahrain — organised by obligation, chapter by chapter.

CBB RULEBOOK · VOLUME 6

CRA Chapter Map

Each chapter governs a distinct obligation. Mapping a product means locating the right chapter.

CRA-1 · Authorisation

Who may operate. Entry requirements and permissions.

CRA-2 · Licensing Categories

Four distinct licence types. Determines permitted activities.

CRA-7 · AML/CFT

Anti-money laundering checks. Includes the Travel Rule.

CRA-8 · Custody

Client crypto-asset custody and segregation. High-risk obligation.

CRA-12 · Conduct

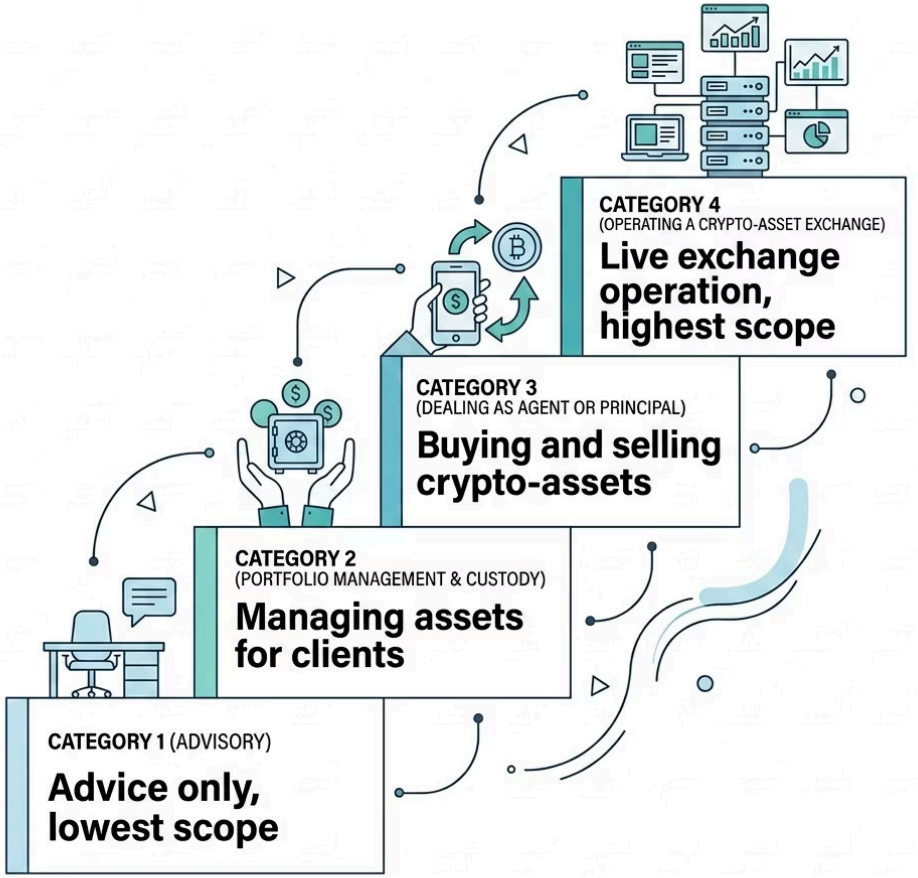
Fair conduct and disclosure. Protects retail users.

CRA-15 · Digital Tokens

Rules specific to digital token offerings.

Always cite at **chapter scope** — never amendment-level detail, which changes over time.

The Four Licence Categories



Key Rule

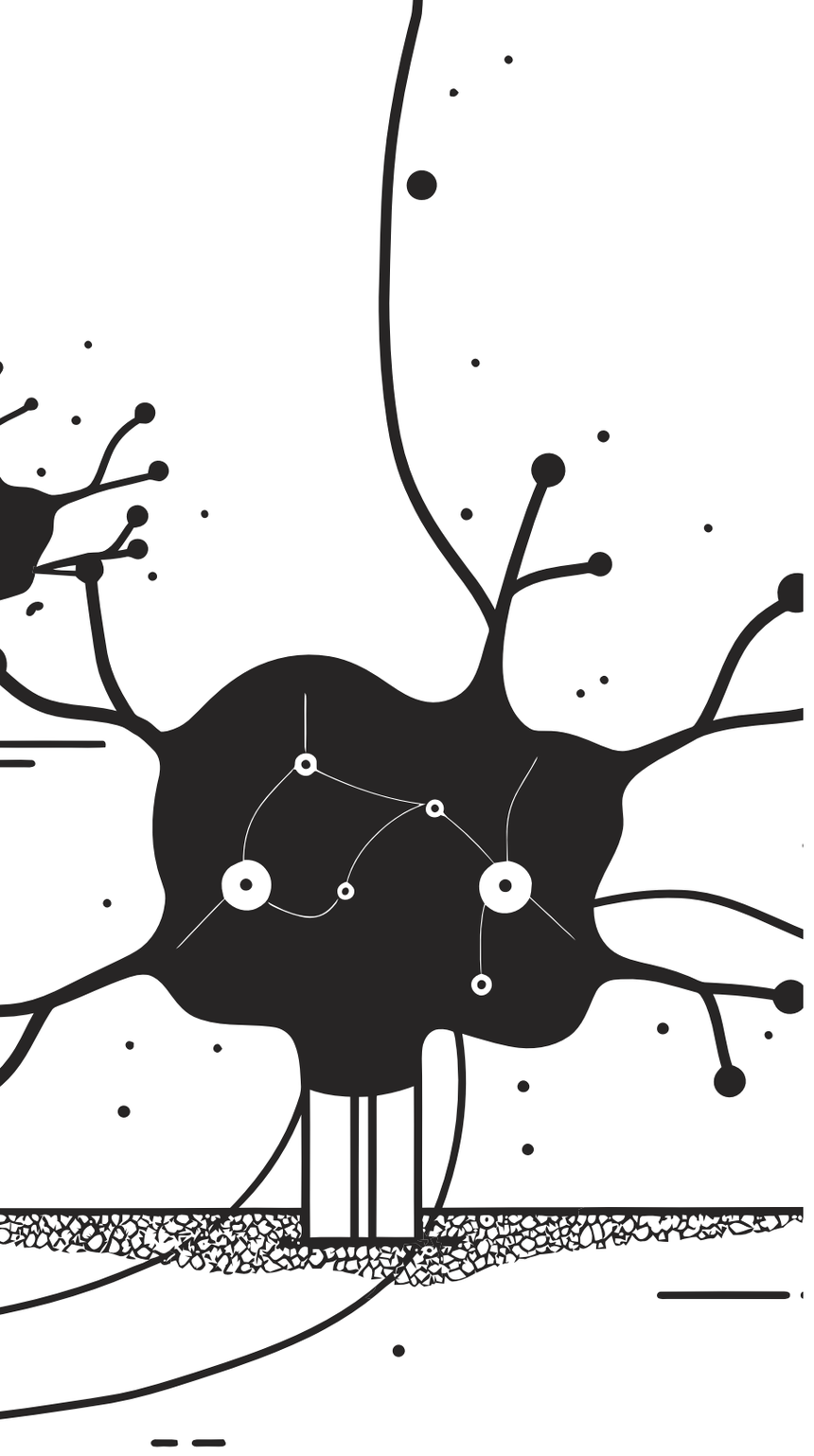
Only **Category 4** permits operating a crypto-asset exchange.

Governed by

CRA-1 sets entry requirements. CRA-2 defines which activities each category may perform.

Practical tip

Before adding any new service, check whether your current licence category covers that activity under CRA-2.



Worked Example: Adding a Staking Service

A Bahraini Category 4 exchange wants to offer staking. Which chapters apply?

1. **CRA-2**
   Does the Category 4 licence cover staking as an activity?
2. **CRA-8**
   Custody and segregation of staked client assets.
3. **CRA-7**
   AML checks on all customers using the staking service.
4. **CRA-12**
   Fair conduct and clear disclosure to retail users.

This is the core skill: **map a product to its governing chapters**, then check each obligation in turn.